SOLACE
CARE

Specialist guide

Every flow a licensed specialist goes through in the Solace Care app: applying, the day's sessions, briefs, notes, homework, reviews and payouts.

For	Solace staff who onboard, support or train specialists: Operations, Support, Finance, QA and the clinical team.
Covers	11 flows, step by step, with the screens, the rules behind each step, the messages people receive and what to do when something goes wrong.
Built from	The screen designs in design/screens, the decision log (docs/decisions.md, D1 to D59) and the specs in docs/specs, as built on 19 October 2026.

Contents

How to read this guide . . . 3
1. Applying to join Solace . . . 4
2. While the application is reviewed . . . 6
3. Today . . . 8
4. Calendar, hours and time off . . . 10
5. Preparing for a session: the brief and prep notes . . . 12
6. Running the session . . . 14
7. Session notes . . . 16
8. Setting homework . . . 18
9. Earnings and payouts . . . 20
10. Reviews . . . 22
11. Profile, documents and account . . . 24

How to read this guide

This guide follows a specialist from their application to their daily work in the app. Each flow has the screens as designed, the steps, the rules the system applies, the messages the specialist receives, and what to do when something goes wrong. The staff side of the same moments (reviewing an application, approving a payout) is in the Admin guide.

Screens. The pictures are the design renders, with fallback fonts and a dashed box where the logo goes. Every screen also exists in French.

Numbers in brackets, such as [15] minutes, are settings with that default; numbers without brackets are fixed decisions.

One app. Seekers and specialists use the same app. After sign-in, a specialist account opens the specialist shell: Today, Calendar, Notes, Earnings and Profile.

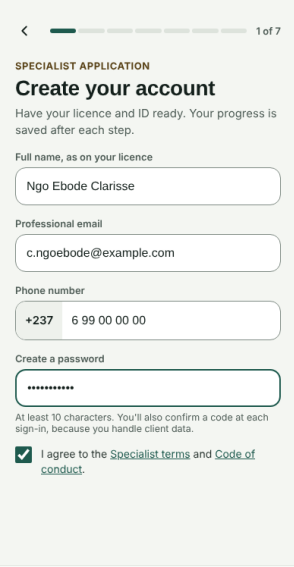
Flag	What it changes for specialists	Default
aiAssist	The pre-session brief, its push and Open the brief on Today	Off
sessionScribe	The AI scribe in the waiting room and AI note drafts	Off
companion	Homework guided by the AI companion for seekers	Off
phoneDialIn	Seekers may join by phone (the specialist joins in the app as usual)	Off
specialistInterviewPicker	Pick an interview time on Application under review	Off
payoutBankTransfer	Bank transfer as a payout method	Off
payoutOnRequest	Pay out now on Earnings (locked off)	Off

FLOW 1

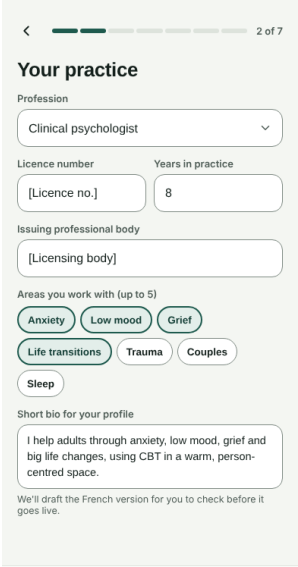
Applying to join Solace

A specialist applies in seven steps: account, practice, languages, documents, sessions and prices, weekly hours and payout details. Progress is saved after each step, and nothing is public until Solace has verified everything.

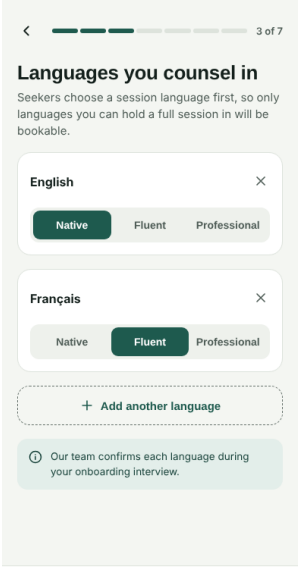
Who	Licensed clinical psychologists, psychiatrists and counsellors. Gynaecologists and endocrinologists are in the catalogue but disabled until physical-health specialists are confirmed.
Screens	Specialist application 1 to 7
Phase	1 · always on



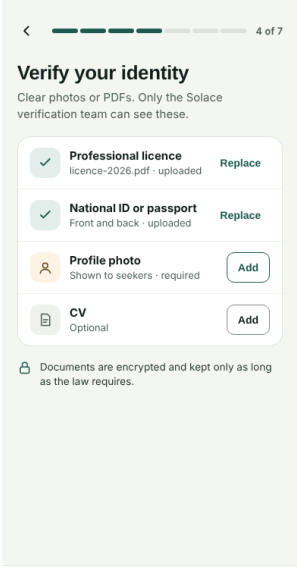
1: account



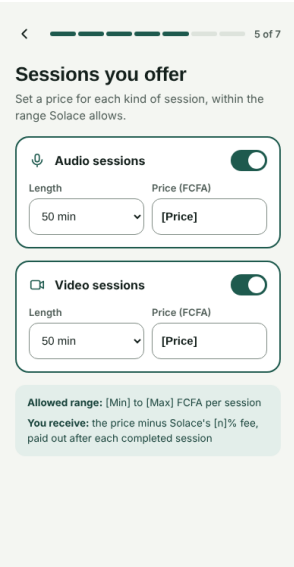
2: your practice



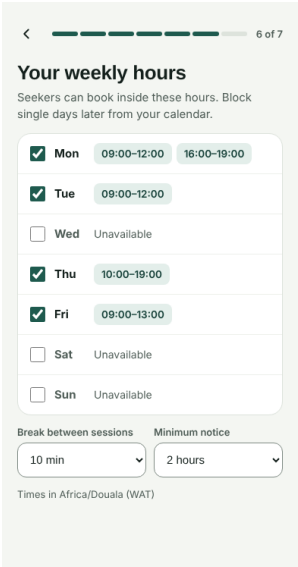
3: languages



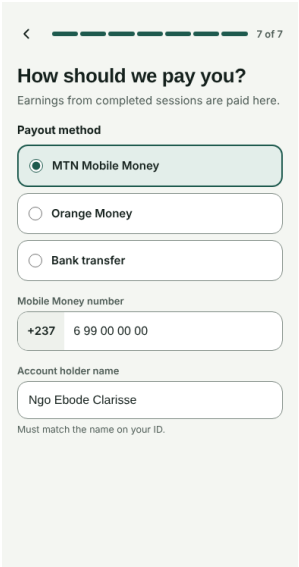
4: documents



5: sessions and prices



6: weekly hours



7: payouts

Step by step

1. **Account**
   Full name as on the licence, professional email, phone number, and agreement to the Specialist terms and the Code of conduct. The phone or email is proven with a one-time code; there is no password (D24), so the design's password field is not in the app.

2. **Your practice**
   Profession, licence number, years in practice, the issuing professional body, up to 5 areas they work with (the same help topics seekers choose), and a short bio in their language.

3. **Languages**
   Each language they can hold a full session in, with a level: Native, Fluent or Professional. Solace confirms each one in the onboarding interview.

4. **Documents**
   Professional licence, national ID or passport (front and back), a profile photo (shown to seekers) and an optional CV. Only the verification team can open them; they are encrypted.

5. **Sessions and prices**
   Audio and/or video, each with a length (30, 50 or 80 minutes) and a price within the allowed range. The screen shows what they receive after Solace's fee.

6. **Weekly hours**
   Hours per weekday, the break between sessions (10, 15 minutes or none) and the minimum notice (2, 12 or 24 hours). Times are in Africa/Douala unless they set another zone.

7. **Payouts**
   MTN Mobile Money or Orange Money number and the account holder's name, which must match the ID. Submit application.

Rules behind this flow

- Prices: [5,000] to [20,000] FCFA per session. Solace's fee is [20]%, taken when the session completes (D27, D28).
- Only languages verified at Professional level or above can be booked (D16).
- The second-language bio is drafted by Solace (a reviewer, or an AI draft the reviewer checks) and the specialist confirms it before the profile goes live (D30).
- Bank transfer waits for a spec of which bank details to collect (payoutBankTransfer flag).

Messages people receive

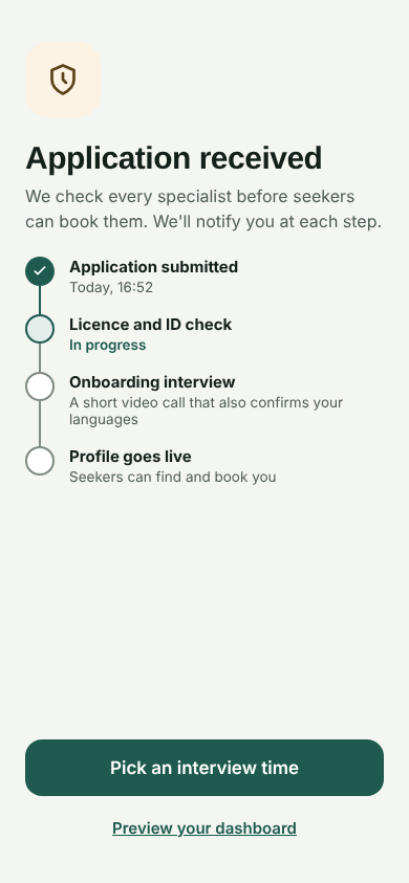
When	Channel	Message (English)
Application received	Push and email	Application received. We'll tell you at each step.

FLOW 2

While the application is reviewed

The specialist sees where their application stands: submitted, licence and ID check, onboarding interview, profile live. Staff book the interview, may ask for a change, and two staff members approve.

Who	Applicants
Screens	Application under review
Phase	1 · the interview picker needs specialistInterviewPicker



Application under review

Step by step

1. **Submitted**
   The application waits for a reviewer (status SUBMITTED, then UNDER_REVIEW).
2. **Licence and ID check**
   A reviewer checks the licence with the issuing body and the identity document, and ticks each item.
3. **Change requested**
   If something is missing, the reviewer sends it back with a reason the applicant reads in the app. They fix it and submit again.
4. **Onboarding interview**
   A short video call that also confirms each language and its level. Staff set the time; the specialist gets a push.

5 **Check the second-language bio**
Before going live, the specialist reads the bio Solace drafted in their other language and confirms or edits it (Profile tab).

6 **Approved**
One reviewer proposes approval after all six items are verified; a second staff member confirms. The profile goes live in search.

Rules behind this flow

- States: DRAFT, SUBMITTED, UNDER_REVIEW, APPROVED, REJECTED, SUSPENDED (D26).
- Approval takes two people; any change to a verified item withdraws a pending proposal (D29). Rejection and change requests take one person.
- Search lists the profile only once the bio exists in English and French and the specialist has confirmed Solace's draft (D31).

Messages people receive

When	Channel	Message (English)
Change requested	Push	Your application needs a change. Open Solace to see what.
Interview booked	Push	Onboarding interview booked: {date} at {time}.
Approved	Push and email	You're approved. Seekers can now find and book you.
Decision made	Push and email	There's an update on your application. Open Solace to read it.

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

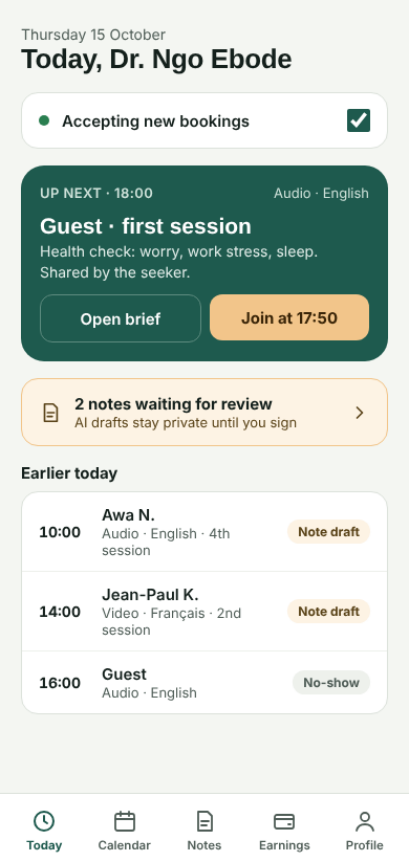
- **Pick an interview time** stays off (specialistInterviewPicker) until someone specifies where interview times come from; staff book the interview instead (D25).

FLOW 3

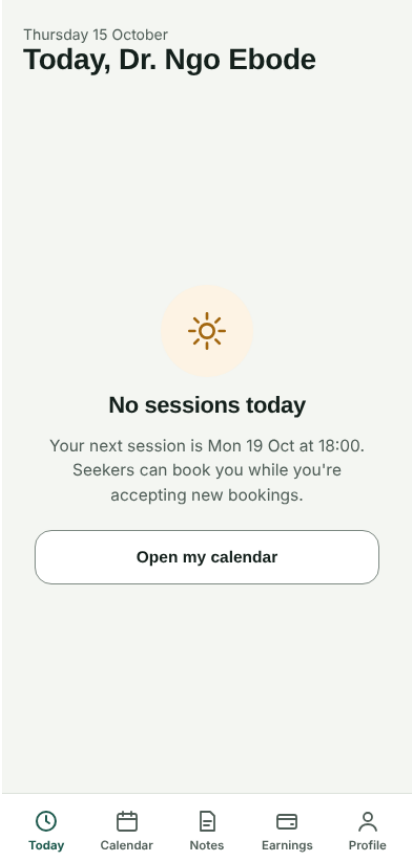
Today

Today opens with the next session: when it starts, who with (the seeker's chosen name, or Guest), whether it is the first session, Join from 10 minutes before and, with AI assist on, Open the brief. Below are the rest of the day's sessions.

Who	Approved specialists
Screens	Today, No sessions today
Phase	1; Open the brief needs aiAssist



Today (as designed)



No sessions today

Step by step

1. **Up next**
   Time, audio or video, the session language, and the seeker's label with which session together this is.
2. **Join**
   Disabled until 10 minutes before ("Join at 17:50"), then opens the waiting room.
3. **Open the brief (AI assist on)**
   See Preparing for a session.
4. **Later and Earlier today**
   Other sessions with their status: confirmed, completed, no-show.

5 **A quiet day**
No sessions today, with the next one and a link to the calendar.

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

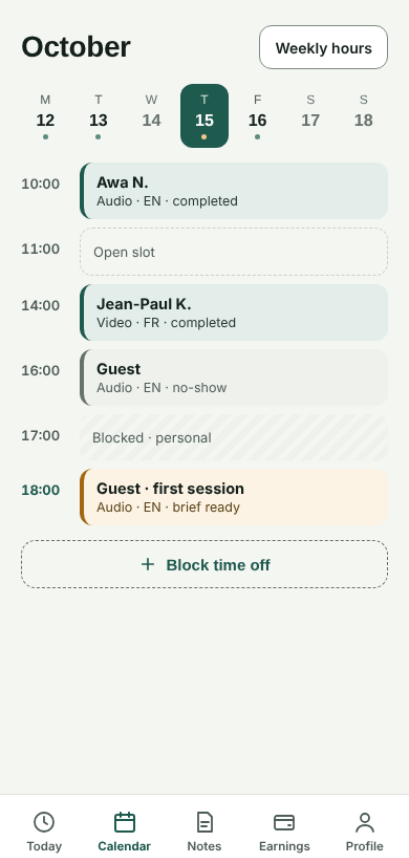
- **Accepting new bookings** (the switch under the date) is designed but not built; a specialist stops new bookings by blocking time off or leaving their hours empty.
- **"2 notes waiting for review"** and the Note draft badges on Today are designed but not shown yet; drafts are in the Notes tab.

FLOW 4

Calendar, hours and time off

The calendar shows the week's sessions, open slots and blocked time. Weekly hours decide when seekers can book; single days or hours are blocked as time off.

Who	Approved specialists
Screens	Calendar
Phase	1 · always on



Calendar

Step by step

1. **Read the week**
   Each session with the seeker label, format, language and status; open slots; blocked time.
2. **Change weekly hours**
   Weekly hours opens the same editor as the application. Existing bookings are kept.
3. **Block time off**
   Pick the dates and times. Seekers can no longer book them; it does not cancel sessions already booked.

Rules behind this flow

- A slot respects the minimum notice and the break between sessions.
- While a seeker pays, the time is held for 10 minutes and nobody else can take it.

Messages people receive

When	Channel	Message (English)
New booking	Push	New session: {date} at {time} · {modality} · {language}.
Seeker cancelled	Push	The session on {date} at {time} was cancelled by the seeker.

If something goes wrong

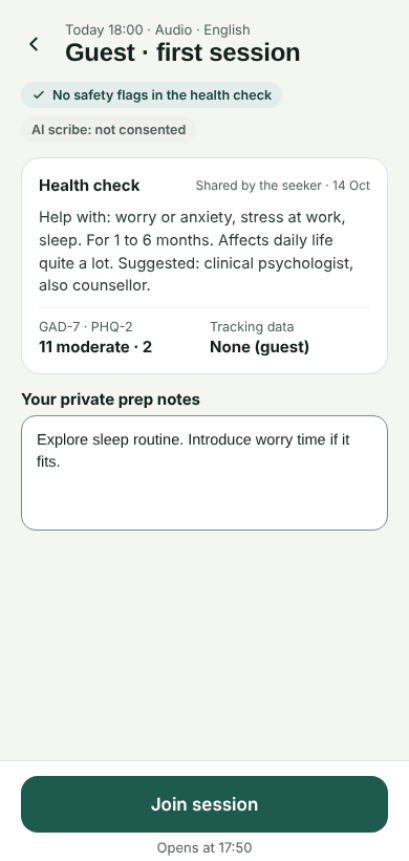
- **The specialist must cancel a booked session:** the seeker gets a full refund and is asked to pick a new time. Do it as early as possible; Support can help if the app does not allow it.

FLOW 5

Preparing for a session: the brief and prep notes

With AI assist on, each booking has a one-page brief: the booking's facts, whether the health check raised a safety flag, whether the seeker consented to the AI scribe, the health check summary they chose to share, and their consented tracking trend. The specialist can also keep private prep notes.

Who	The booking's specialist only
Screens	Pre-session brief
Phase	3 · needs the aiAssist flag; the AI tracking summary needs the PRE_SESSION_BRIEF feature live



Pre-session brief

Step by step

1 **Open the brief**
From Open the brief on Today, or the push "Your brief for the 18:00 session is ready" sent [60] minutes before.

2 **Read the top**
When, audio or video and language; Guest or Registered; First session; "No safety flags in the health check" or that it stopped at the safety question; AI scribe consented or not.

3 **Health check**
Shown only when the seeker ticked Share for this booking: when it was shared, a plain summary (what they want help with, for how long, how much it affects daily life, the suggestion), and the screener totals with their published bands.

4 **Tracking data**
Shown only when the seeker has a sharing grant for this specialist: lines of what was logged over the last 14 days. With AI on, two or three sentences may be worded by AI from those lines only, marked as such.

5 **Prep notes**
Private notes for this booking. Only this specialist reads them; nothing else does.

6 **Join**
Opens from 10 minutes before.

Rules behind this flow

- No AI ever reads health check answers. The summary is built by rules from the shared answers (D8, D56).
- Every read of health check answers or tracking is recorded in the audit log as the specialist's read.
- Screener totals and bands are for the specialist only; seekers never see them.
- Prep notes are deleted if either person erases their account.

Messages people receive

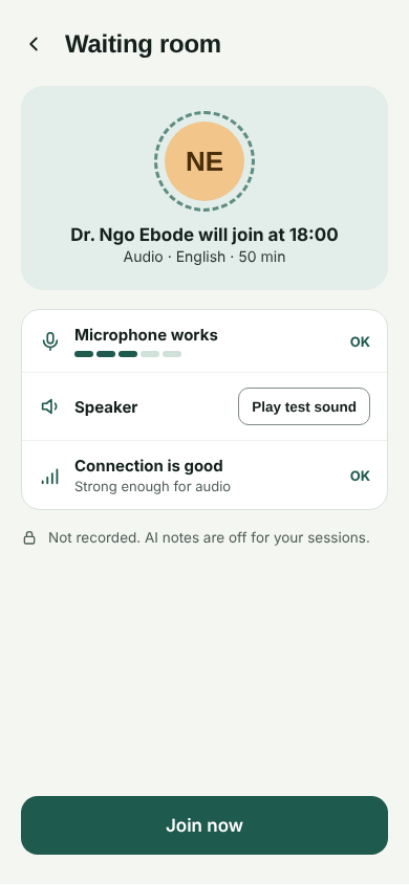
When	Channel	Message (English)
Brief ready	Push	Your brief for the {time} session is ready.
10 min before	Push	Your {language} session at {time} starts in 10 minutes.

FLOW 6

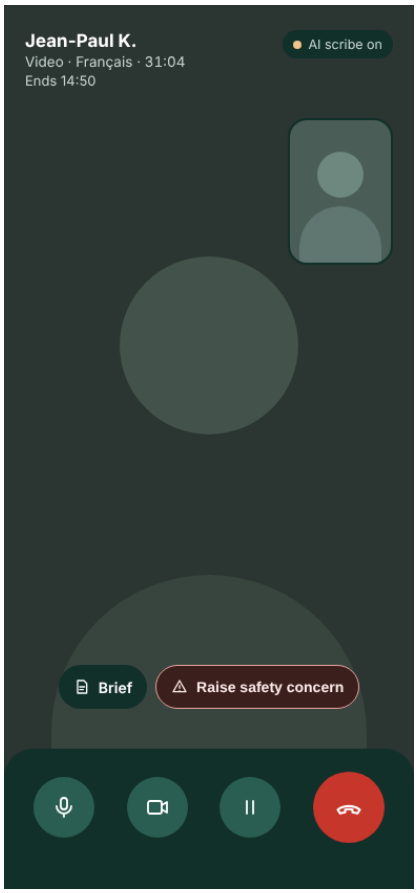
Running the session

The specialist joins from the waiting room. If the scribe is on and both consented, either person can turn it off for this session. The call holds on weak connections and keeps a dropped person's place for 2 minutes.

Who	The booking's specialist
Screens	Waiting room, In session (specialist, video)
Phase	1; the scribe needs sessionScribe



Waiting room



In session (specialist view)

Step by step

1. **Waiting room**
   Microphone and connection checks. When the scribe can run: "AI scribe for this session" with a switch to turn it off for this session.

2. **Join now**
   The session starts when both are in the room. The seeker may be in the app or, when phone dial-in is on, on a phone call.

3. **During the session**
   "AI scribe on" shows while audio is recorded. Turning the scribe off stops the recording at once.

4 **End**

The session completes when the room closes after both attended, or [15] minutes after the scheduled end.

Rules behind this flow

- Audio is recorded only when the flag is on, the seeker is registered, both have AI session notes consent, and neither turned it off for this session (D57).
- Participants join the media server as "seeker" and "specialist"; no names go to it (D36).
- **No-shows:** [15] minutes after the start, if only the specialist joined, the seeker is a no-show and the specialist keeps the session's earnings; if only the seeker joined, the specialist is a no-show and the seeker is refunded in full.

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

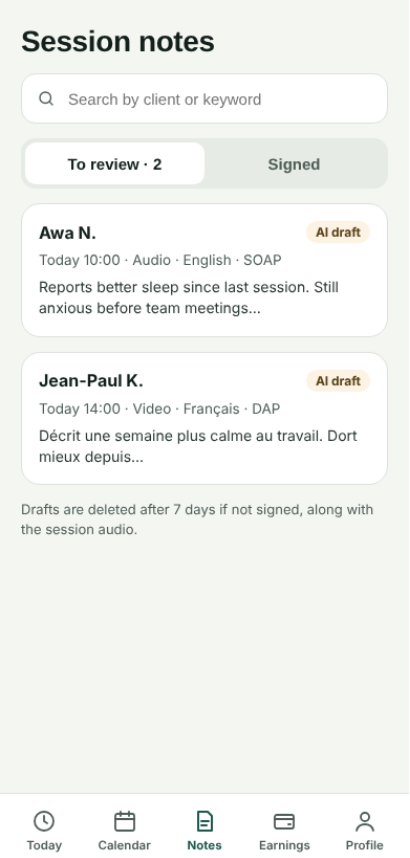
- The **Seeker waiting** push ("Your seeker is in the waiting room.") is in the notification copy but not sent yet.
- **Raise safety concern** in the in-session screen is designed but not built. If a specialist is worried about a seeker's safety, they act as they would clinically and contact the crisis team through Solace's on-call channel.

FLOW 7

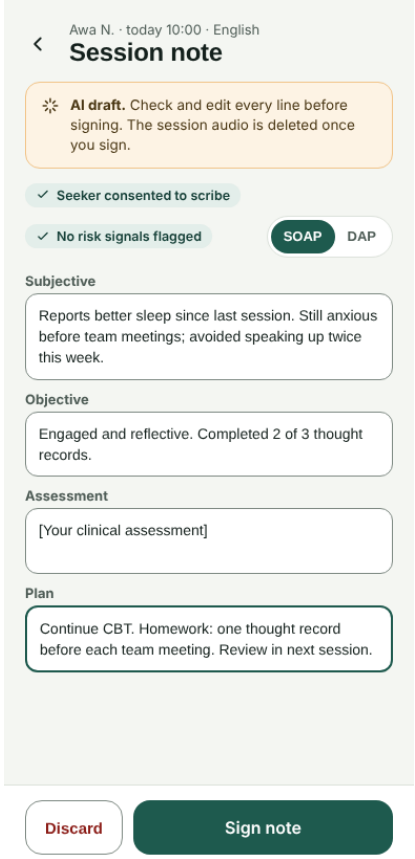
Session notes

After a session with the scribe on, a SOAP draft waits in Notes: the AI writes only what was said and always leaves the assessment empty. The specialist checks and edits every line, writes the assessment, and signs. Signing deletes the transcript and the audio.

Who	The booking's specialist only
Screens	Notes, Review note draft
Phase	4 · needs sessionScribe; AI drafts need the SESSION_SCRIBE feature live



Notes



Review note draft

Step by step

1 **Open Notes**
To review (with the count) and Signed. Search finds words in the notes. Each row: the seeker, when, format, language, AI draft, and the first line.

2 **Open a draft**
"AI draft. Check and edit every line before signing. The session audio is deleted once you sign." It shows that the seeker consented, and whether risk signals were flagged in the session.

3 **Choose SOAP or DAP**
Switching drafts the note again from the transcript in the other format, replacing the current text.

4 **Edit and write the assessment**
Subjective, Objective (or Data), Assessment, Plan. The assessment is the specialist's clinical judgement and always starts empty.

5 **Sign note**
Available once every section is written. The note becomes read-only; the transcript and the audio are deleted.

6 **Or discard**
Deletes the draft, the transcript and the audio.

7 **Assign homework**
From a signed note, see Setting homework.

Rules behind this flow

- Transcription runs only on a model hosted by Solace; session audio never goes to a foreign model without the transfer authorisation (D56, D57).
- Risk signals in a transcript are shown to the specialist and do not raise a crisis alert: the specialist was there and decides.
- A draft not signed within 7 days is deleted with its transcript and audio.
- Notes and transcripts are encrypted. Every read is in the audit log. Staff screens never show notes.
- If transcription or drafting fails, or the AI scribe is not live, the specialist gets an empty draft to write themselves.

Messages people receive

When	Channel	Message (English)
Note draft ready	Push	A note draft is waiting for your review.

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

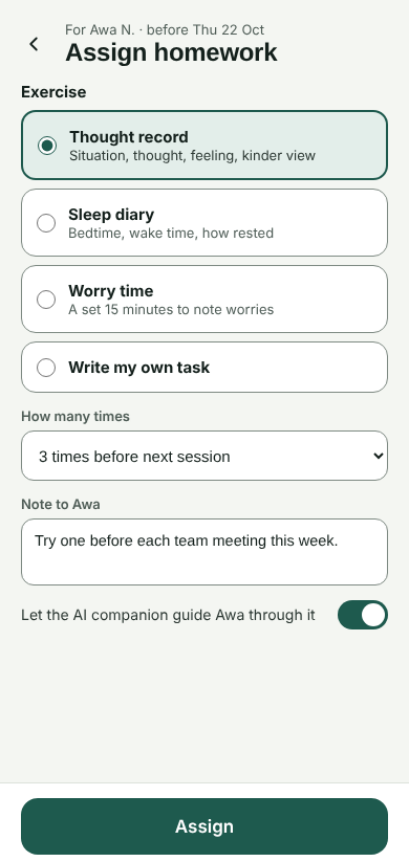
- Whether Solace is the record keeper for signed notes is an open legal question. For now a signed note stays with its specialist, and is deleted if either person erases their account.

FLOW 8

Setting homework

After a session with a registered seeker, the specialist sets homework: a thought record, a sleep diary, worry time or their own task, a number of times, daily or once, with a note, and optionally guided by the AI companion.

Who	The specialist of a completed session with a registered seeker
Screens	Assign homework
Phase	4 · seekers see it with the companion flag



Assign homework

Step by step

1. **Pick the exercise**
   Thought record (situation, thought, feeling, kinder view); Sleep diary (bedtime, wake time, how rested); Worry time (a set 15 minutes to note worries); or Write my own task.
2. **How many times**
   A number of times before the next session (1 to 14), Daily, or Once.
3. **Write a note**
   A message to the seeker, shown with the homework.
4. **Let the AI companion guide them**
   On by default. The companion walks the seeker through each step and checks every answer for risk first.

5 **Assign**
It is due before the next booked session, or after [7] days.

Rules behind this flow

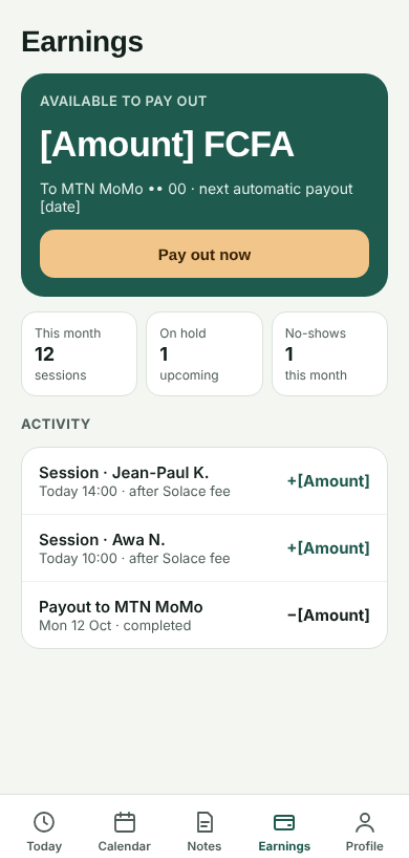
- Homework can be set only after the session has ended, and only for a registered seeker (not a guest).
- The specialist sees how many records are done, never the seeker's words.
- If an answer shows a risk signal, the companion stops, opens urgent help for the seeker and raises a crisis alert.

FLOW 9

Earnings and payouts

Earnings show what is available, what is on hold for upcoming sessions, no-shows and every session and payout. Payouts go automatically twice a month to the mobile money account on file.

Who	Approved specialists
Screens	Earnings & payouts
Phase	1 · Pay out now is locked off



Earnings & payouts

Step by step

1. **Read the balance**
   Available to pay out, the method, and the next automatic payout date.
2. **This month**
   Sessions, on hold (upcoming paid sessions), no-shows.
3. **Activity**
   Each completed session after Solace's fee, and each payout.

Rules behind this flow

- Money is held from payment until the session completes, then released to the specialist less Solace's [20]% fee; the fee in force at payment time applies (D35).
- If the seeker cancels late or does not show up, what the policy does not refund goes to the specialist like a completed session, less the fee.
- Payout runs cover the 1st to the 15th and the 16th to the month's end. Finance submits each run and a different Finance member or a Super admin approves it (D14, D35).
- Items with an open dispute or failed payout details are held out of a run.

Messages people receive

When	Channel	Message (English)
Payout sent	Push	Payout sent: {amount} FCFA to {method}.
Payout failed	Push and email	Your payout couldn't be sent. Check your payout details in Solace.
Payout statement	Email	Your Solace payout, {period}. {amount} FCFA was sent to {method}.

If something goes wrong

- **Payout failed:** usually a wrong or closed wallet number. The specialist corrects Payout details in Profile; Finance retries in the next run.

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

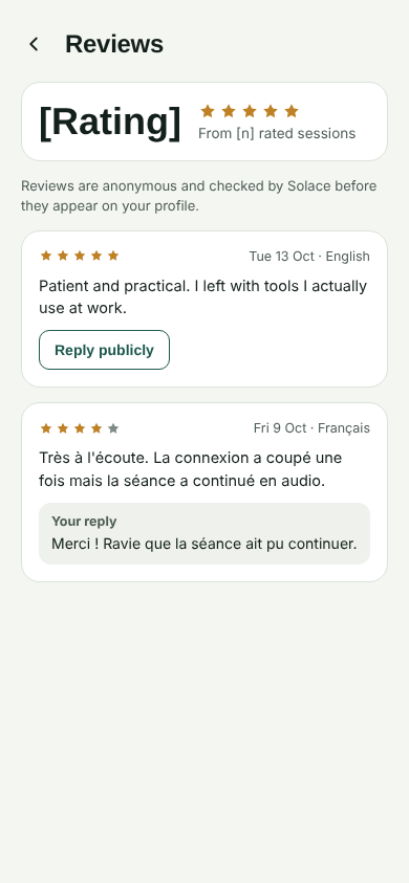
- **Pay out now** is locked off: an off-cycle payout would skip the two-person run (D35).

FLOW 10

Reviews

Seekers rate each completed session. Stars count towards the specialist's average at once; written reviews appear only after Solace moderates them, and never show who wrote them. The specialist may reply once, publicly.

Who	Approved specialists
Screens	Reviews
Phase	1 · always on



Reviews

Step by step

1. **Read reviews**
   The average, the number of rated sessions, and each published review with its date and session language.
2. **Reply publicly**
   One reply per review.

Rules behind this flow

- The rating shows in search only from [3] ratings (D37).
- A reply with a phone number, email or link is refused; write it again without them.
- Private feedback a seeker sends to the Solace team is never shown to the specialist.

Messages people receive

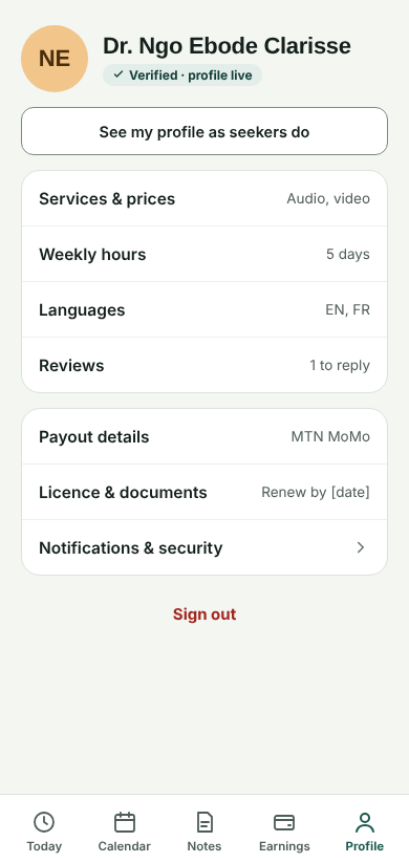
When	Channel	Message (English)
New review	Push	You have a new review.

FLOW 11

Profile, documents and account

The Profile tab shows the verified status, the profile as seekers see it, services and prices, weekly hours, languages, reviews, payout details, and notifications, privacy and settings.

Who	Approved specialists
Screens	Profile tab
Phase	1 · always on



Profile tab

Step by step

1. **See my profile as seekers do**
   Opens the public profile.
2. **Confirm the second-language bio**
   When Solace drafted it, a card asks the specialist to check it before the profile goes live.
3. **Services, hours, languages, payout details**
   Each opens its editor.
4. **Privacy, notifications and settings**
   As for seekers: AI session notes consent (needed for the scribe), reminders, discreet mode, language.

5 Leaving Solace

A specialist's account deletion is a data request that Operations works through, because licence documents, payouts and records need checking (D40).

Not live yet / waiting on a decision

- **Licence renewal** ("Your licence expires on {date}. Upload the renewal to stay bookable.", 60 days before) is in the notification copy but not sent yet; Operations tracks licence dates on the Specialist record.